

Introduction: Theory into Practice

This report is a personal reflection on the group project for the COMP4035 module. My goal is to assess my performance, our collaboration as a team, and what I learned about project management. After discussing various agile approaches, including the risk-focused Spiral model, our group made a strategic decision to adopt the Scrum framework for its iterative and adaptive structure. We used Discord for our online communication, additionally in-person meetings during our practical's. This approach was something I was responsible for justifying in my part of the report. I argued that this would make us flexible and effective. While the framework itself was adaptive, my own understanding of its practical application was incomplete. While it was challenging it taught me far valuable experience than expected. This reflection is an honest account of the gap between the well-laid plans and the complicated adaptation to working cooperatively.¹

The Role and Its responsibilities

The contribution to the project began before roles were formally assigned, by initially contacting and emailing the group to schedule our starting meetings. This helped get the project going. While every section was equally crucial for the project, “system-development process” came with responsibilities of creating a framework that would connect the other sections. It was important to propose adaptive methodologies for members working on “System Capabilities” and “Testing. A concern was proposing a model that theoretically laid out a structured plan but behaved impractical through writing. To lower risks the ideas were discussed with the team early on to take on early feedback in our roles and simply ensuring a clear final report.

A significant challenge was the strict 500-word limit. Compressing weeks of lectures and research through learned knowledge into a considerable small format was difficult. Another challenge was justifying the use of Discord. While the team understood its practical benefits for rapid communication, framing a less formal tool within an academic report required careful justification, focusing on its function as a modern, connective platform that aligns with agile principles.

¹ Devxhub (2023). *Tips and Tricks for Efficient Project Management with Discord*. Medium. Available at: <https://devxhub.medium.com/tips-and-tricks-for-efficient-project-management-with-discord-38a6a8c34589>

Reflecting on the process, a key strength was helping establish the projects initial framework. Following with agreements to work with Scrum and Discord in the first meeting provided a working path. However, a personal weakness became apparent when the team, through a slight miscommunication in the third meeting, I hesitated to step in due to an initial social disposition of adapting to a new group of people I hadn't collaborated with before. This was a mistake, but a learned lesson that constant feedback is required. This was overcome as the entire team, myself included developed a habit of being more active and communication, which helped break down any initial social walls.

How Our Team Worked

Our projects progress was steady and set by six meetings. As the person tasked with the methodology section, we considered different approaches. The Spiral model was discussed for its strong risk assessment approach, but we concluded that for a project of this scale, the overhead wasn't necessary. When proposing the core Scrum framework, which everyone agreed was a better fit and we also decided to use Discord for communication. By our second meeting, I presented my report justification for Scrum, and the team officially adopted the plan.

Things were going smoothly until the third meeting, when we noticed a slight miscommunication. This represented a "storming" phase, where different interpretations could have led to conflict. So, in our fourth meeting, I suggested we take a clarification session. We just talked through everything until we were all on the same page. This was a required step to keep us on track. The last two meetings were about bringing everything together. We reviewed the combined report to check for consistency, and I made sure the other sections still lined up with the methodology. Our final meeting was as a simple proofread before we submitted the assignments.²

The slight conflict which became apparent through members working on "System Capabilities" had a slightly different understanding of the user stories than the member working on "Testing". The issue was managed by the clarification meeting which underlined requirements one by one until everyone was in the same page. Efficiently managed which highlighted the importance of clear feedback, additionally synergising our planning methods.

² Institute Project Management (2022). *The 5 Stages of Team Development*. Institute Project management. Available at: <https://instituteprojectmanagement.com/blog/the-5-stages-of-team-development/>.

What I Learned

This Project taught me that project planning isn't about creating a perfect, static plan. It's an approach adaptive to human error and miscommunications that likely happen within most working teams. Our choice of Scrum proved itself effective. While the Spiral mode's intense focus on risk analysis was ideal, we understood that the agile Scrum nature was suitable for a project of this scale, driven by Industry examples. Methods such as Waterfall which I argued against in my report, due to possible inconsistencies which may have been seen late into our project timetable.

Additionally, I learned that planning is an ongoing process not a document you interactive with once. Our initial plan was just a starting point, effective planning happened through our meetings, especially our feedback sessions. That's the agile approach we inherited through learning the module. Discord wasn't simply a convenient messaging app; it was a support structure between our in-person meetings. It provided efficient feedback and rapid availability even through the team's busy schedules.³

Conclusion

Therefore, this project served as a practical lesson in the gap between planning a process and structuring it. The decision to choose the adaptable Scrum framework was collaboratively acknowledge, not because the plan was "perfect" but because it gave the team the tool to navigate through their sections simultaneously, unplanned moments such as the slight miscommunication were managed through efficient feedback. On a personal level, the project highlighted the interest in teamwork, as the initial role of "methodology justification" turned to be that individual roles require constant wider communicative approaches. Moving forward, the adaptive mindset supports the flexible requirement of managing digital technologies.

³ Team, T.S. (2024). *Improving project collaboration with Discord and Statsig*. Statsig.com. Available at: <https://www.statsig.com/perspectives/improving-project-collaboration-with-discord-and-statsig>.

Meeting Notes

Meeting 1:

Date Friday 10th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Reviewed the coursework specification and confirmed who would be taking which section.

George: Domain Analysis, Guilherme: Methodology, Guido: Capabilities, Ethan: Social, legal implications, Grace: Testing

Meeting 2:

Date Tuesday 14th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Presented researched, agreed to adopt the Agile Scrum framework as our methodology to ensure a consistent and structured report.

Meeting 3:

Date Friday 17th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Exchanged and reviewed first drafts, providing feedback. Identified that the “Testing” and “System capabilities” sections needed to be more linked to Scrum framework.

Meeting 4:

Tuesday 21st October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Final review of all 500-word reports. Agreed on referencing style for the structure and submission.

Meeting 5:

Friday 24th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Proofreading of group Submission report, 500 words were agreed as Submission ready from all members.

Meeting 6:

Thursday, 30th October 2025, 30-40 minutes

Walkthrough of requirements for the individual task (1000 words).

Final report structure submitted together through an in-person meeting.